

THE WAY OF WATER

Causing The Motion

The project explores how movement can become the primary language of a garment. Developed from an investigation into designs that reveal themselves through motion rather than stillness, the project draws inspiration from the shifting reflections of light on the floor of a swimming pool. These fleeting patterns only exist in flux, continuously changing with the movement of water and the viewer's perspective.

The resulting garment translates this phenomenon into a wearable form. Through layers, transparency, and optical interaction, the dress creates a constantly transforming surface that echoes the fluid, intangible qualities of reflected water. Rather than presenting a fixed image, the design unfolds over time, inviting the viewer to experience it through movement.

The project culminated in a video created in collaboration with Bart Hess and performed by ballerina Jessy van den Elzen. The slow-motion format allowed the subtle transformations of the garment to be fully observed, highlighting the relationship between body, motion, and material. In this time-based work, the dress becomes both costume and moving image, existing most completely in motion.